KiqStat CTO review: first pass, full report

Where all 25 checklist items stand, what was found, what was built, and what the second pass needs. 6 November 2026

1. Is the first pass done?

Yes, for everything that can be done without you. The CTO's Complete Work Review of 4 November became a 25-item checklist. Every item that Claude owns alone is finished. What is left either needs a decision, a figure or an action from the founder, an outside party (legal), or an event that has not happened yet (the X posts, the first partner payment, the ₦500 pass trial ending on 7 November). Those are the inputs for the second pass.

Status	Items	Count
Done by Claude	1.2, 2.1, 2.3, 2.4, 3.1, 3.4, 4.2, 4.3, 5.4	9
Closed by the founder	1.1, 1.6	2
Claude's part done, waiting on you or an event	1.3, 1.4, 1.5, 4.1, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 5.2	8
Open, needs the founder or an outside party	2.2, 2.5, 3.2, 3.3, 5.1, 5.3	6

Nothing built in this pass is live yet. All code is on the `dev` branch (latest commit `9baa60b`, 1,305 tests passing). It reaches customers only when you merge `dev` into production and promote the deployment.

2. The headline findings

1. **Revenue is small and mostly one-off.** October collected ₦77,250 from 13 paid orders (about ₦74,900 after estimated fees). 43 people tried to pay and 65 attempts failed or were abandoned. Of the paid orders, 9 were one-off and 3 recurring.
2. **October did not cover its estimated fixed costs** of ₦95,000 to ₦108,000 a month, so it fell about ₦20,000 to ₦33,000 short. These are estimates until the invoices arrive (2.2).
3. **Margin per customer is healthy; the number of customers is the problem.** Every plan clears the 25% margin target in normal use, at any of three exchange rates (₦1,400, ₦1,550, ₦1,700), with a 0%, 20% or 35% partner. A 35% partner commission fails the target in the worst case, so it should not be promised.

4. **Ask KiqStat's AI cost is immaterial** (about US$0.001 a question) but had a real hole: cancelled calls were under-booked. Fixed.
5. **Checkout loses most buyers.** 22 of 262 accounts have ever paid; 36% of the 61 who reached checkout completed it. Paying once converts about three times better per attempt than a card subscription. No one has paid twice.
6. **A VIP renewal was missed on 24 October** (Paystack charged, access ended). The cause is still unconfirmed, but the code is now robust to both possible causes and a daily check catches anything missed.
7. **Most of the site's "visitors" are not people.** Vercel counted 30,592 October visitors, but only 2,376 are Nigerian and they average 7.3 pages each; everyone else averages 1.2 pages. The sign-up page alone had 10,904 non-human-looking visitors. The 263 signups themselves look like real people.
8. **Source tracking was broken until about 26 October.** 129 of 256 real accounts have no recorded source. Of the sources we can see, ChatGPT is the best: 40 signups, 8 payers (20%), ₦45,000, 43% of attributed revenue.
9. **Search and AI engines send almost nothing yet** (about 113 Google visitors, 4 from ChatGPT in 30 days), although the site's technical SEO is already good.
10. **The partner system had never handled real money** (3 partners, 3 referred signups, none paid) and had one gap: a Paystack refund left the partner's commission standing. Fixed.

3. All 25 items

Priority 1: Production safety

#	Item	Status	Result
1.1	Anthropic workspace spending limit	Closed by founder	Set at US$20 a month
1.2	Ask preflight and switch	Done	Preflight green in production; offline tests pass; Ask switch confirmed on
1.3	Backup and recovery	Claude's part done	Supabase is on the Pro plan (daily backups kept 7 days, no point-in-time recovery, 864 MB). Runbook `docs/backup-recovery.md` and an off-site weekly backup written; the first run was green. **You:** Backups screenshot and a test restore
1.4	Real ₦500 VIP pass, receipt and refund	Waiting on founder	The 31 October purchase is in our records. **You:** refund the test pass and confirm the receipt
1.5	VIP renewal anomaly	Claude's part done	Renewal handling rebuilt (`docs/renewals.md`), `/admin/renewals` page, dashboard alert, daily Paystack subscription check, recovery for lost payments. **You:** Paystack's webhook log for the 24 October ₦12,000 charge, which will name the cause

#	Item	Status	Result
1.6	Booking codes and live win bar	Closed by founder	Verified: 100 of 102 member codes read back correctly from SportyBet; refusals (about 45% of attempts) are correct but a usability issue to follow up

Priority 2: Financial baseline

#	Item	Status	Result
2.1	October revenue statement	Done	`revenue-statement-2026-10`. Four-month table: Aug ₦700 (1 order), Sep ₦13,400 (3), Oct ₦77,750 incl. a ₦500 test (14), Nov to the 5th ₦13,500 (4). **You:** Paystack export to reconcile and give real fees
2.2	October cost invoices	Open, founder	Vercel, Supabase, TheSportsDB, Sendbyte, domain
2.3	Plan-by-plan model	Done	`scripts/plan-economics.ts` and `plan-economics-2026-11`. Largest partner commission that still leaves 25%: 72% typical, 31% to 37% worst case
2.4	Free tier cost and operating profit	Done	Free and guest Ask cost under ₦11 in five weeks; fixed costs spread over 240 active accounts are about ₦400 to ₦450 each. Operating result is an estimate until 2.2
2.5	Allowance versus cap per plan	Open, founder decides	A VIP member's day ends at about 82 questions, not the 100 promised, because the US$0.10 day cap bites first. Raise the cap or lower the allowance; Pro (30 a day, about US$0.025) fits its US$0.04 cap

Priority 3: AI sustainability

#	Item	Status	Result
3.1	Offline verification	Done	Cancelled Ask calls are now booked for the text already streamed and the prompt sent (`src/lib/ask/engine.ts`, two new tests)
3.2	Live benchmark, 40 questions × 5 configurations (about US$4)	Open, both	The lab at `/admin/ask-lab` is ready and `ANTHROPIC_TEST_API_KEY` is in Vercel. **You:** redeploy so it takes effect, run the five presets and rate the answers; then I analyse and recommend
3.3	Ledger reconciled with Anthropic billing	Open, both	**You:** Anthropic billing figures for October and November to date
3.4	Margin and abnormal-usage alerts	Done	Daily cron `/api/cron/ask-watch`, rules in `src/lib/ask/watch.ts`, one email per finding per day

Priority 4: Analytics, growth and marketing

#	Item	Status	Result
4.1	Signups are people; site visits	Partly done	Signups verified and filtered (7 of 263 set aside). Site visits answered from Vercel (see finding 7). **You:** GA4 figures and whether Mixpanel's bot filter is on
4.2	Source carried through to payment	Done	Admin → Traffic → Revenue by source. The page was also corrected so accounts with no recorded source are no longer shown as "Direct"
4.3	Pass conversion and upgrades	Done	`conversion-and-free-tier-2026-11`. The ₦500 pass upgrade check is due 8 November
4.4	X captions, sequence, tagged links	Drafted	`x-pack-2026-11`: 14 captions, a 14-day sequence, tagged links under campaign `nov26-test`. **You:** approve or edit; check against Nigerian advertising rules
4.5	48-hour and 7-day reviews	Procedure ready	`docs/campaign-review.md`; runs once posts go out
4.6	SEO plan, widened to the whole site and every AI engine	Drafted and partly built	`seo-geo-plan-2026-11`. Built on `dev`: IndexNow daily push, pricing structured data, permanent competition pages, six question-style guides, a sharper Track page title, a citation block in `llms.txt`. **You:** Search Console and Bing access; agree the head-to-head clean-up

Priority 5: Partner Agreement V2

#	Item	Status	Result
5.1	Founder's questionnaire answers	Open, founder	
5.2	Commission schedule	Drafted	`partner-commission-and-referrals-2026-11`: 20% of net for 12 months as standard, 25% for named partners, a 30% ceiling, no 35%. **You:** approve
5.3	Legal and tax	Open, founder and legal adviser	
5.4	Referral tracking end to end	Done	Chain checked link by link; the reversal function was run on the live database inside a rolled-back transaction. Paystack refunds now reverse the partner commission automatically. The first real payment through a partner link has still to be seen

4. What was built (all on `dev`, not yet live)

Area	Change
Billing	Daily Paystack subscription check; payment recovery for lost webhooks; robust renewal detection with cycle fallbacks; failed-renewal email to the member; `/admin/renewals` with a dashboard alert; automatic partner-commission reversal on a Paystack refund
Reliability	Settlement of finished games every minute (migration 0100, applied to production); off-site database backup
Ask KiqStat	Cancelled calls booked correctly; daily margin and abnormal-usage watch; Ask lab for the live benchmark
Picks	Ordered top picks, frozen at publish for games from 6 November (`predictions_log.top_picks`, applied to production); Code Hub plan tag; pick integrity written up
Analytics	Signups filtered to people; revenue by source on the Traffic page; accounts without a recorded source kept apart from direct traffic
SEO and AI answers	IndexNow; pricing structured data; competition pages at `/football/competition/<code>` with each competition's own settled record; six guide articles; `llms.txt` citation block; Track page title
Docs	Backup runbook, renewals runbook, campaign review procedure, and the reports below

Checks: typecheck and lint clean; 1,305 tests pass. I have not seen the new pages or the Traffic page rendered in a browser.

5. Reports delivered (reference index)

Every report exists as Word and PDF in `docs/reports/` and was sent to you as it was produced. Earlier reports predate the CTO review and are included so this document points to the whole set.

Date	Report	What it covers
29 Oct	`ask-kiqstat-cost-audit.pdf`	Technical and cost audit of Ask KiqStat
29 Oct	`ask-kiqstat-cost-controls.pdf`	Findings on the spending controls
29 Oct	`ask-kiqstat-staging-margin.pdf`	Staging verification and margin floor

Date	Report	What it covers
4 Nov	`model-audit-fixes-2026-11.pdf`	Model audit fixes and replay results
4 Nov	`forge-code-hub-audit-2026-11.pdf`	Forge and Code Hub audit, replay labs, live grading SQL
5 Nov	`revenue-statement-2026-10`	2.1 October revenue statement
5 Nov	`plan-economics-2026-11`	2.3 per-plan margins and partner commission limits
5 Nov	`traffic-and-sources-2026-11`	4.1 and 4.2 signup quality and revenue by source
6 Nov	`x-pack-2026-11`	4.4 X captions, 14-day sequence, tagged links
6 Nov	`seo-geo-plan-2026-11`	4.6 whole-site SEO and AI-engine plan, Grok first
6 Nov	`conversion-and-free-tier-2026-11`	4.3 pass conversion, 2.4 free-tier cost
6 Nov	`partner-commission-and-referrals-2026-11`	5.2 schedule, 5.4 referral check
6 Nov	`data-totals-xg-2026-11.pdf`	Data, market totals and xG audit (model work on `dev`)
4 to 6 Nov	Claude Doc "KiqStat: CTO Review Progress"	The live version: findings, decisions, checkpoint log (https://claude.ai/artifact/LDRt5B5Y3M4AKmCDVzmeL9)

Supporting documents in the repository: `docs/cto-review-checklist.md`, `docs/backup-recovery.md`, `docs/renewals.md`, `docs/pick-integrity.md`, `docs/campaign-review.md`.

6. What the second pass needs from you

Do first, because everything else depends on it

1. Merge `dev` into production and promote the deployment.

2. Set the `INDEXNOW_KEY` variable in Vercel (any string of letters, digits and dashes) to switch on IndexNow.

Inputs that unlock Claude's remaining work

For	What
2.1, 2.2, 2.4, 4.3	Paystack transaction export for October (real fees, decline reasons); October invoices for Vercel, Supabase, TheSportsDB, Sendbyte and the domain
1.5	Paystack webhook log for the 24 October ₦12,000 charge
1.3	Supabase Backups screenshot; a test restore
1.4	Refund the 31 October ₦500 test pass; confirm the receipt
3.2	Redeploy, run the five presets in `/admin/ask-lab`, rate the answers
3.3	Anthropic billing figures
4.1	GA4 October visitors, sessions and landing pages; Mixpanel bot-filter setting; whether the 24 October signup spike matched a campaign
4.6	Search Console and Bing Webmaster access; agree the head-to-head clean-up; name an author for the guides; approve the competition explainers

Decisions

For	Decision
2.5	Allowance versus cap per plan (VIP currently ends the day at about 82 questions)
4.4	Approve or cut the 14 X captions; advertising-rule check; send the carousel images and the week's fixtures
5.2	Approve 20% standard, 25% named, 30% ceiling, no 35%
4.3	Make pay-once the default on the pricing page
4.6	Keep AI training crawlers blocked until scraper traffic is rate-limited (my recommendation: yes)

Outside parties

5.1 the questionnaire answers; 5.3 legal and tax with your adviser.

Events that will arrive on their own

- 7 November: the ₦500 trial ends; 8 November: the upgrade check runs.
- 8 November: the two Pro card plans renew, the first live test of the renewal code.
- When X posts go out: 48-hour and 7-day reviews (4.5).
- The first real payment through a partner link: confirms 5.4 with money.

7. Honest limits

- Revenue and cost figures are cash received and estimates; the invoices and Paystack export will replace the estimates.
- Search, ranking and AI-mention results are unmeasured because I could not see Search Console, Bing, GA4 or any AI engine's own reporting.
- Grok has no documented crawler, so nothing on the site can tune for it directly; the plan relies on the X account.
- Small samples throughout (22 payers, 8 ChatGPT payers): treat rankings as leads, not results.
- The refund fix and the new pages are covered by type checks and unit tests, not by a live end-to-end run.